EKLAVYA UNIVERSITY
ज्ञानप्राप्तये लक्ष्यसन्धानम्
Estd. by Madhya Pradesh Niji Vishvavidyalaya (Sthapana Avam Sanchalan)
Sagar Road, Damoh - 470661
MADHYA PRADESH, BHARAT

INTERNATIONAL DANCE CONFERENCE

on

Bharatiya Classical Dance Heritage

TRADITION | TRANSFORMATION | TRANSCENDENCE

19-21 December, 2026



Dear Distinguished Colleague,

Subject: Invitation to Participate in the International Conference on Bharatiya Classical Dance Heritage, organized by Eklavya University, Damoh, Madhya Pradesh, from 19-21 December. 2026, at Damoh.

It is my privilege to invite you to join a gathering we believe will mark a watershed moment for the study and future of Bharatiya classical dance. For all its extraordinary richness, the world of Indian classical dance today carries an unresolved inheritance. The Nāṭyaśāstra and the wider body of Nāṭyaśāstrīya literature preserve a remarkably sophisticated and detailed technical vocabulary — hastas, karaṇas, aṅgahāras, cārīs, maṇḍalas, and much else — yet no single, shared, textually-grounded reference exists today that dancers, teachers, and researchers across schools, states, and countries can turn to in common. The result is a quiet but real confusion: the same term interpreted differently in different institutions, the same movement traced to different textual roots depending on where one trained, and in different texts, generations of students inheriting divergence where there might instead be dialogue.

This conference is conceived to address that gap directly. Its central purpose is not performance, though performance and demonstration will have their place, but sustained comparative scholarship: bringing textual specialists, Sanskritists, art historians, archaeologists, and practicing dancers of multiple classical traditions into the same room, to examine where the sources concur, where they genuinely diverge, and what that divergence tells us about the history of the form. Over three days, approximately one hundred national and international delegates will work through structured sessions towards this end, with the explicit aim of producing a lasting reference compendium — a shared point of departure, not a final word — for the reconciliation of technique and terminology across Bharatiya classical dance.

We regard this compendium, and the scholarly consensus-building process that will shape it, as a resource intended to outlive the conference itself: for teachers structuring a curriculum, for students seeking to understand where a movement comes from, and for researchers building on a foundation that has, until now, been fragmented across texts, schools, and generations rather than gathered in one place.

The conference will address, among its principal research topics, the study and comparative representation of :

Aṅga, Pratyanga and Upanga movements (the major, minor and subsidiary limbs), Abhinaya and Hastābhinaya; Sthānaka; Cārī; Maṇḍala; Karaṇa; and Aṅgahāra in classical and semi-classical prevalent dance styles, together with their representation in the visual and sculptural arts, their references across the Nāṭyaśāstra corpus of texts.

Contact

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Your contribution in the field of dance as dance practitioner/ guru/ dance scholar and connoisseur with your unique point of view will add immense value to this conference. We would be honoured to have you join us — whether as a presenter of research, a discussant, a practitioner offering the perspective of embodied tradition, or a participant in the conference's working sessions — and to have your voice shape a resource that dancers, teachers, and future researchers will draw upon.

The conference is scheduled to be held from 19 to 21 December 2026, at Eklavya University, Damoh, Madhya Pradesh. Further details regarding the thematic sessions, paper submission, and travel arrangements will follow under separate cover.

We would be grateful if you could confirm your consent to participate at the earliest, by writing to us at idc@eklavyauniversity.ac.in or call on the given contacts given below.

Anjali Sunderam : +91 9752874630, **Dr. Nidhi Asati : +91 9575053647,**
Tapan Kumar Sahoo : +91 7205265711

It would be a privilege to welcome you to Eklavya University for what we hope will be remembered as a defining moment in the scholarly life of Bharatiya classical dance—development of uniform dance pedagogy across institutions and regions. There are limited funds for travel which can be availed on first come first serve basis. The details regarding working sessions and themes of the conference are referred to in the enclosed brochure.

With warm regards and in anticipation of your participation.

Dr. Sudha Malaiya
Chancellor,
Eklavya University,
Damoh, Madhya Pradesh

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